Broncos keep on dancing

Santa Clara beats Maryland to advance—Cardinal faces No.1 seed UMass

SPORTS DAY

TODAY
Stanford vs. Massachusetts
9:15 a.m. Ch. 5

WEATHER: Sunny. High 77, low 49. Details, A-2.

SATURDAY: March 16, 1996

The Oakland Tribune.

FIFTY CENTS

FRIEND OF THE PEOPLE IT SERVES

★★ LATE SPORTS FINAL

UC plans to build new headquarters in downtown

Officials have eyes on vacant 12th Street lot

By Diane Williams and Mary Rajkumar
STAFF WRITERS

SAN FRANCISCO — The University of California wants to construct an eight-story headquarters for its president in downtown Oakland on a city-owned block that has been idle for years, Oakland and UC officials confirmed Friday.

The decision to enter negotiations for the 12th Street lot ends months of speculation about where the UC Board of Regents would locate its Office of the President.

The office now leases 13 floors in Oakland's Kaiser Center, bordering Lake Merritt. The new building would be about eight blocks to the southwest, closer to BART and downtown.

Landing a prestigious tenant downtown — and finally developing the vacant block — would be a bittersweet victory for city officials because the move represents a loss for one of Oakland's largest business centers.

City officials took pains Friday to note that UC's decision to leave Kaiser was theirs alone and that at least the office will remain in Oakland.

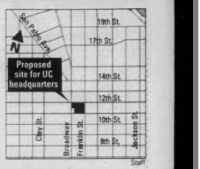
"We were not the ones who approached UC; they declared they were looking for a new site," said Councilmember Ignacio De La Fuente (San Antonio-Fruitvale). "If they leave, people will accuse us of not doing everything in our power to hold on to them."

The proposal brought sharp criticism from Kaiser Center officials, who sent letters to regents and Gov. Pete Wilson this week arguing that building a new UC facility will cost taxpayers more than if UC continued to lease its current space.

Although plans are still preliminary, UC's proposal calls for building a 200,000-square-foot headquarters with "campus-like" landscaping and the capacity to handle high-tech equipment.

If negotiations are successful, UC would move into the new building when its lease at the Kaiser Center expires in May 1998.

Oakland would likely lease the land to UC for a nominal fee and subsidize parking, city sources said. In exchange, the city is banking on a major economic development boost for the area, which is a patchwork of struggling



Staff

Please see **UC**, A-6

Cigarette firm may cough up $2 billion

By Robert L. Jackson and Henry Weinstein
LOS ANGELES TIMES

WASHINGTON — In a second precedent-setting settlement of tobacco litigation, the Liggett Group agreed Friday to pay a huge sum to resolve a lawsuit involving tobacco-related illnesses among residents of five states.

Under the terms, Liggett agrees to pay potentially as much as $2 billion over the next 25 years and pledges to make cigarette advertising reforms that include abandoning the use of cartoon characters that appeal to teen-agers.

The settlement was announced by the attorneys general of Mississippi, Florida, Massachusetts, West Virginia and Louisiana.

Those states had filed lawsuits seeking compensation from the tobacco industry for costs incurred by taxpayers in treating smoking-related diseases contracted by indigent citizens.

No admission of guilt

These Medicaid-related costs have ranged from $60 million a year in West Virginia to $400 million in Florida.

Liggett's settlement with the states follows by two days its agreement to resolve a large class-action lawsuit in New Orleans that alleged cigarette makers manipulate nicotine levels to keep smokers addicted. In both cases, there was no admission of guilt or liability by Liggett, a unit of Brooke Group Ltd. and the nation's fifth-largest cigarette maker.

Each case involves a commitment by Liggett to begin complying with certain proposed Food and Drug Administration regulations governing smoking by teen-agers.

Abandoning cartoon characters

The company will abandon the use of cartoon characters like RJR Nabisco Holdings Corporation's popular "Joe Camel" in tobacco advertising. It also will limit the use of promotional materials and the distribution of free samples where minors are present.

Mississippi Attorney General Mike Moore, who led months-long negotiations that resulted in the settlement, said the most important goal was "protection of the public health of this country, primarily the children."

While Liggett's break puts pressure on the other defendants to settle, Moore said officials will continue to pursue legal action against

Please see **Smoke**, A-6

RON RIESTERER — Staff

LAYING 'O THE GREEN — Oakland Coliseum groundskeeper Leo Valle sprays water on the new turf in preparation for the March 31 preseason game between the Oakland A's and the San Francisco Giants. The stadium is undergoing a $90 million renovation to accommodate both the Oakland Raiders and the A's. Crews have been working around the clock, seven days a week — even in the rain — to get the stadium ready for baseball.

Airline pilots approaching 'free flight'

ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Within a decade, airline pilots may be able to fly where they want, as fast as they want and at the altitudes they want under an air traffic control plan announced by the Federal Aviation Administration.

The new system, called "free flight," will let pilots choose their routes, taking advantage of favorable winds and avoiding storms as they cross the nation.

Air traffic controllers, who now dictate most routes, will still keep watch to make sure planes don't come too close.

"Free flight really means a more flexible way of managing air traffic," Federal Aviation Administrator David R. Hinson said Friday.

"I think we now have a blueprint for the future of the air traffic control system," said Robert W. Baker of American Airlines.

"Free flight is synonymous with benefits for everyone," added David Watrous, chairman of the government-industry panel that developed the plan.

He said benefits will include improved safety, faster travel and reduced operating costs for airlines.

But Hinson noted that instituting the plan is a long and complicated project expected to take at least 10 years.

Complex electronic gear will keep air traffic controllers informed of where planes are and allow them to step in and order route changes when aircraft approach one another too closely.

While free flight will be available to all

Please see **Pilots**, A-6

Getting closer — maybe

Settlement not in bag, strike negotiators say

By Michael Bazeley
STAFF WRITER

OAKLAND — Speculation that the Oakland teachers' strike may be resolved in the next day or two intensified Friday, but negotiators said a deal was still far from done.

Representatives from the school district and the Oakland Education Association remained camped out at the Oakland Airport Hilton, meeting almost nonstop to put together a three-year labor deal for teachers.

Salaries, class size and early retirement remain the major issues.

One negotiator said talks were progressing steadily but slowly.

"We're talking, but as far as saying we'll be done by Sunday or whatever, I wouldn't go that far," the negotiator said.

Negotiators said one of the sticking points was disagreement over the district's ability to pay for the union's contract demands. A contract proposal crafted by Mayor Elihu Harris is one of the documents being studied, district officials said.

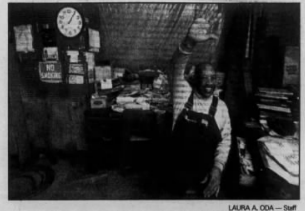
Teachers have been on strike since Feb. 15, missing 21 consecutive school days as of Friday. It is the longest teachers' strike in the city's history. Teachers also struck twice earlier this year for a total of three days. Nearly 52,000 students at 90 schools have been affected by the walkouts.

On Friday, school district officials remained optimistic, saying they hoped to have children back in school early next week.

The district told principals Thursday that the union would ratify a new labor pact early Monday morning. But union officials said no such meeting had been

OAKLAND SCHOOLS STRIKE
SCHOOL DAYS MISSED: **21**

Please see **Strike**, A-6



LAURA A. COA — Staff

At age 69, SuperLotto winner Dan Martin of Oakland still gets marriage proposals, but he stopped counting when they numbered 57.

Lottery luck better late than never

This is the last of six reports on California's SuperLotto millionaires. Today: Old cars, new money.

By Tom Goff
STAFF WRITER

OAKLAND

Luck of the DRAW

DAN MARTIN drove his old Ford Torino wagon with its back full of junk down to his body shop and parked. He walked to the wedge-shaped, tin-sided building on the corner, opened the bay door and sat in the same old chair by the same old metal desk.

The shop was barely large enough to hold the remains of an old Ford and a Chevy. Their hoods were covered with canvas and car parts, the remnants of jobs gone by. In the years when the shop was taking in $10,000 a year, his specialty was life after death. He would find two dead wrecks and transform them into one working vehicle.

That was then. He doesn't do the big jobs anymore. Someone came by and asked him if he could fix a stuck window. He said he could.

It was the kind of light work his 69-year-old body has tolerated since he threw out his back and pulled a leg muscle bending over a car. When the weather gets bad, his leg aches. When the rain blows through the shop door, he just stays home.

The weather being fair, he sat near the sidewalk in his overalls and nylon jacket, waving to friends, gabbing with the neighborhood folks who could mark their calendars by him.

They have seen Dan come to his West Oakland business nearly every workday for 14 years. They know the pattern is as unchanging as the shop and the man, unaltered by either the wearing years or a $6.1 million SuperLotto jackpot.

Please see **Lotto**, A-6

One-of-a-kind depot foreman leads retirees' parade

By Kathleen Kirkwood
STAFF WRITER

ALAMEDA — His co-workers say it may take some convincing to get 75-year-old Isiah Dixon to actually leave the Alameda Naval Aviation Depot.

In 46 years, the electronics foreman never took advantage of his three-week annual vacation leave or sick time. Dixon has worked on just about every type of aircraft the fleet brought to the depot.

He explains it as only an aircraft technician could: "Physics tell you it's easier to maintain momentum than it is to overcome inertia."

Then he adds, "It costs more fuel to get a plane in the air than it does to keep it flying."

Dixon, with nearly five decades under his belt, was the most senior among 99 retirees honored Friday at a retirement ceremony at the 55-year-old Navy repair depot Friday.

That leaves some 450 civilian workers at the depot, down from 3,000 just three years ago.

Destined to close this year, the depot was once the largest industrial complex in the East Bay, where technicians took apart and put back together missile guidance systems, engines and airplanes.

The depot ushered out its last aircraft this month — an upgraded EP-3E Aries spy plane — and is closing down all its shops at the end of the month. Remaining employees will be charged with packing up and performing environmental cleanup tasks. In September, the Navy will lock all the doors.

"It's been a real emotional thing. It's like a death in the family," said Jeanne Russell, who first met her husband, Randy, at the depot. Both have worked there 27 years and retired Friday.

The base closure announcement in 1993 came as a shock to employees, who had watched the Navy invest millions in the Alameda repair base.

"We've past the anger and all those things," Jeanne Russell said. She worked with Dixon for many years and attested that "you'll never find a more dedicated employee here."

Dixon, she said, even gave some of his never-used sick time to an employee who needed it to keep a job.

Although he doesn't have any specific plans in mind for retirement, Dixon said he plans to devote a little more time to the "Dixon Swingers," a 17-piece band for which he plays bass.

Good morning

The lost comrade

Fifty-one years after being shot down, survivors search for the remains of the only member of their B-17 crew who didn't make it out. **[A-4]**

Read, then recycle
We are recycled paper

All in a row

A group of teen-age rowers tests its limits at the crack of dawn on the Oakland Estuary. **[A-7]**

BUSINESS DAY	A-10	LANDERS	B-7	RELIGION	B-9
CLASSIFIED	C-1	LEGALS	A-9	SCOREBOARD	C-9
COMICS	B-6	LOCAL NEWS	A-2	SPORTS DAY	C-1
CROSSWORD	B-6	LOTTERY	A-2	STOCKS	A-12
GARDEN HOMES	L-1	MOVIES	B-3	TELEVISION	B-8
HOROSCOPE	B-2	OBITUARIES	A-9	WEATHER	A-2

© 1996 Alameda Newspaper Group

123rd Year, No. 24